COMPARISON · SPLIT · STRUCTURE

compare-prose

Two prose options side-by-side with a labeled corner tag on each.

Renew at list price, or hold the discount.

HOLD THE PUBLISHED RATE

Protect the list price and signal pricing discipline to the rest of the base. Risks four at-risk accounts worth $2.1M ARR walking at renewal.

❯

EXTEND THE LEGACY DISCOUNT

Keep the four accounts by carrying their 2023 pricing one more year. Buys retention now, but the discount has already leaked to two prospects in the same segment.

What writing decisions down actually changed.

BEFORE

Decisions lived in the room they were made in. Six months on, nobody could say why we killed the project — only that someone senior had felt strongly.

→

AFTER

Every decision is logged with its signals, its options, and the bet it made. We still relitigate, but now there is a record showing we already decided this in March.

Same comparison, columns swapped.

FIRST OPTION

Now rendered on the right, second in the reading order. Useful when the natural argument flow wants the alternative considered before the lead.

❯

SECOND OPTION

Now rendered on the left. Pair with `chosen` to mark the swapped position as the verdict.

The right card is the verdict.

BUILD IN-HOUSE

Full control of the schema and roadmap, but 2–3 engineer-quarters before feature parity. Maintenance burden stays internal.

❯

BUY + CONFIGURE

Ships in 6 weeks, not 9 months. Engineering capacity redirects to product-layer features; exit risk is manageable via contractual data export.

Build vs buy — decided.

BUILD IN-HOUSE

Full control of the schema and roadmap, but 2–3 engineer-quarters before feature parity. Maintenance burden stays internal.

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BUY + CONFIGURE

Ships in 6 weeks, not 9 months. Engineering capacity redirects to product-layer features; exit risk is manageable via contractual data export.

Long-body options stacked for room.

BUILD IN-HOUSE

Full control over the schema and the roadmap, with 2–3 engineer-quarters before feature parity. Ongoing maintenance burden stays internal; the team owns every escalation, every migration, every breaking change. Worth it when the data model is the differentiation; expensive when it isn't.

❯

BUY + CONFIGURE

Ships in 6 weeks rather than 9 months, with engineering capacity redirecting to product-layer features the customer actually pays for. Exit risk is bounded by contractual data export; switching cost is a known number rather than a moving target. The right call when the data layer is plumbing rather than differentiation.

Three reasons we are building.

BUILD	WHY NOT BUY	WHY NOT DELAY
The platform is the product. Owning it owns the roadmap.	No vendor matc[illegible]our compliance posture without [illegible]ender of control.	Cost of waiting compounds: each quarter spent on workarounds is one fewer quarter on the platform.

We went with managed Postgres, not the self-hosted cluster.

MANAGED POSTGRES

Higher monthly spend, but zero on-call burden and automatic failover. The team ships features instead of babysitting replication.

❯

SELF-HOSTED CLUSTER

Cheaper raw compute, but the operational tax — patching, backups, 3am pages — falls on a four-person team that can't absorb it.

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When NOT to reach for compare-prose.

Code comparison. Use `compare-code` for two fenced blocks. compare-prose is for sentences, not snippets.

Three or more options. compare-prose is strictly two. For three or more, use `cards-grid three` or `verdict-grid` with criteria badges.

Verbatim text differences. When the diff lives inside the prose itself — legal language, contract clauses — use `redline` so insertions and deletions render inline.

RELATED COMPONENTS

See also.

`compare-code` — the columns are code, not prose

`split-compare` — the verdict needs a bottom recommendation bar

`verdict-grid` — three or more options scored against shared criteria

`decision` — the verdict slide that lands after a comparison